

Travel History Documentation Guide

How to compile and present your past travel and visa history clearly - a well-organized travel history can actively strengthen your application.

Why Travel History Matters

A clean, well-documented travel history - especially prior visits to visa-strict countries with no overstays or violations - is a quiet but genuine point in your favor. It shows a visa officer you understand and follow the rules of international travel.

What to Compile

- ☐ Copies of all visa pages in your current and previous passports (approved, refused, or expired)
- ☐ A simple table listing: country visited, dates, purpose, and visa type used
- ☐ Any prior visa refusal letters, with the stated reason for refusal
- ☐ Evidence of on-time returns from previous trips, where relevant (old boarding passes, entry/exit stamps)

If You Have No Prior International Travel

This is completely normal and not a weakness by itself. Focus your energy on the other categories - strong financial documentation and a clear, specific study plan matter far more to most visa officers than a travel history.

If You Have a Prior Refusal (Any Country)

Always declare it

Never omit a previous visa refusal, even for a different country or visa type. Immigration systems increasingly share data, and an undeclared refusal discovered later is far more damaging than an honestly declared one. Briefly explain what changed since the refusal - stronger finances, a clearer study plan, or corrected documentation.